

April

Some April dates:

- 1 **April Fools' Day** Little is know about the origins of this tradition but setting a day aside for harmless pranks on other people has been common throughout the world. Bet we've all got some memories of good ones!
- 14 **Holy Week** beginning with Palm Sunday commemorating Jesus' entry into Jerusalem when palms were laid in his path
- 18 **Maundy Thursday** commemorating the Foot Washing and the Last Supper. The Queen gives out silver coins (Maundy money) to elderly people

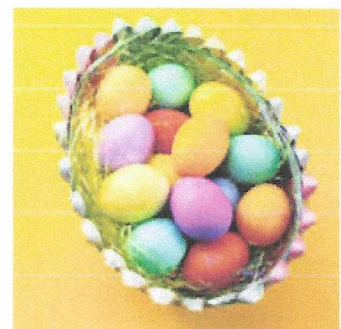


- 19 **Good Friday**
Commemorating the crucifixion. Hot cross buns



- 21 **Easter Sunday**
Commemorating the resurrection after 3 days. The most important day of the year for some people

- 22 **Easter Monday** Easter traditions include egg dying, painting and rolling. Well remember being one of the Lancaster schoolchildren flocking to Giant Axe Field to roll our precious haul of hard-boiled eggs. This tradition still carries on to this day in Preston. And not long ago our family used to roll our eggs down Wittenham Clumps. Pace Egging still a tradition in Lancashire and West Yorkshire



Much more commercialized nowadays with chocolate eggs!

April

*April brings the primrose sweet,
Scatters daisies at our feet.*

Sarah Coleridge



And don't forget – April showers bring forth May flowers

April info



- Derives its name from the Latin verb *aperire* – to open
- More trees and flowers beginning to open their buds in April
- Anglo-Saxons called April *eostre-monat* after their goddess Eostre
- And Eastre is the root of the word Easter
- Finnish name *huhtikuu* – slash-and-burn moon when farmland's cleared
- Slovene name *mali traven* – when plants start growing

April's flowers of the month

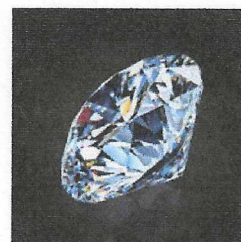


Daisy

or

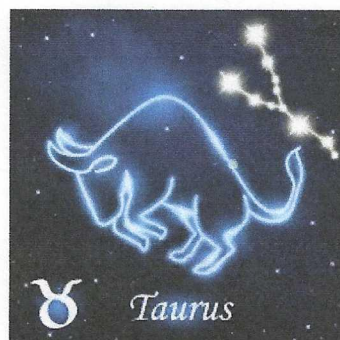
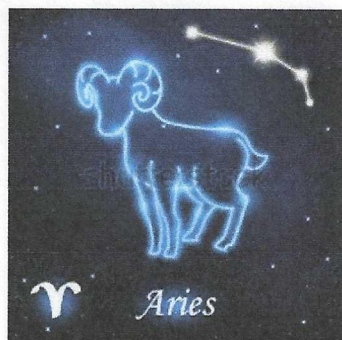


Sweet Pea



is the diamond

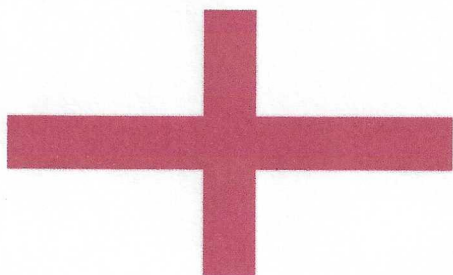
April's zodiac signs are both 4-legged hooved creatures



April

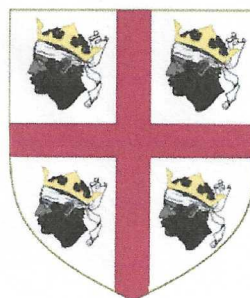
23 St George's Day St George was adopted in England because the dragon-slaying legend was similar to an Anglo-Saxon legend.

Born in Cappadocia, part of modern day Turkey, he was executed on 23 April 303 for refusing to give up Christianity.



The St. George's flag, a red cross on a white field, was adopted by England and the City of London in 1190 for their ships entering the Mediterranean to benefit from the protection of the Genoese fleet.

Nearly 200 years later Edward III made St George the patron saint of England. He's also the patron saint of Aragon, Catalonia, Ethiopia, Greece, Lithuania, Paestine, Portugal, Russia and Georgia with is named after him. And his day is celebrated widely in the Middle East.



Tradition has it that *Jerusalem* is sung in cathedrals, churches and chapels on the Sunday near St George's Day.

NB *Jerusalem* is the WI's anthem.

23 **William Shakespeare** is celebrated. He died on 23 April in 1616

24 **St Mark's Eve** when ghosts of those doomed to die within the year eerily glide through church doors

Other Awareness Days in April:

Autism Awareness Month and National Pet Month

3 International Children's Book Day on Hans Christian Anderson's birthday

7 World Health Day and the London Marathon

10-16 Homeopathy Awareness Week

17 World Haemophilia Day

22 Earth Day

23 World Book and Copyright Day